

July 2026

Whispers of Wonders



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Editorial



Welcome to another exciting issue of our magazine! This month, the world came together to celebrate the thrill of the Soccer World Cup, reminding us that teamwork, determination, and fair play can inspire people across the globe.

We would also like to say a heartfelt **thank you** to our growing family of young readers. It has been wonderful to see children of all ages enjoying the magazine—even readers as young as **4-year-old Prakriti Acharya**, who especially enjoys fun activities like *Spot the Difference*. Your curiosity, creativity, and enthusiasm inspire us to make every issue more exciting than the last.

As you turn these pages, you'll also discover amazing animals, journey through space, explore a recent scientific discovery, and enjoy creative artwork and fun activities.

Happy reading!

Aadrita Chattopadhyay
Editor-in-Chief



Curiosity corner

A close-up photograph of a young duckling, likely a Mallard, standing in a field of green grass and white daisies. The duckling has brown and yellow feathers, a dark eye, and a long, slightly curved beak. It is looking towards the right. The background is a soft-focus green field.

The Animal Kingdom

From the deepest oceans to remote forests, animals live in extraordinary ways. Dive into these stories and uncover some of the amazing secrets of the natural world.



The Remarkable Rescue of the Kakapo

By Debashis Chakraborty



Kakapo (kākāpō) is one of the world's most unusual birds. Native to New Zealand, it is the only flightless parrot on Earth. With its moss-green feathers, it blends so well into the forest that it can almost disappear among the ferns.

Just a few decades ago, only 51 Kakapos were left in the world. It seemed that they might disappear forever. To save them, the New Zealand government carried out an amazing rescue mission. For the first time in history, every remaining Kakapo was carefully flown by helicopter to a safe, predator-free island. They also removed rats from the islands as rats loved to eat Kakapo eggs. But the birds still did not breed often. It was discovered that female kakapos usually lay eggs only when rimu trees produce lots of calcium-rich fruit

to help build the Kakapo egg shells, which happens every 2–6 years.

Thanks to years of hard work, their population has grown to more than 240 birds. Kakapo eggs are considered more valuable than diamonds.

Fun Facts:

- Kakapos are the world's heaviest parrots, weighing up to 4 kilograms.
- They can live for 60–100 years.
- Their body exude a sweet smell that many people compare to honey and resin.



The Wonderful Whales

By Pavel Steshenko



This summer I went on a whale watching trip. It was one of the coolest adventures ever!

At first there was thick fog, so we couldn't see any whales. Then the fog cleared. Our guide told us that bubbles on the water can mean whales are feeding below. My favorite moment was when a whale lifted its huge tail before diving deep into the ocean.

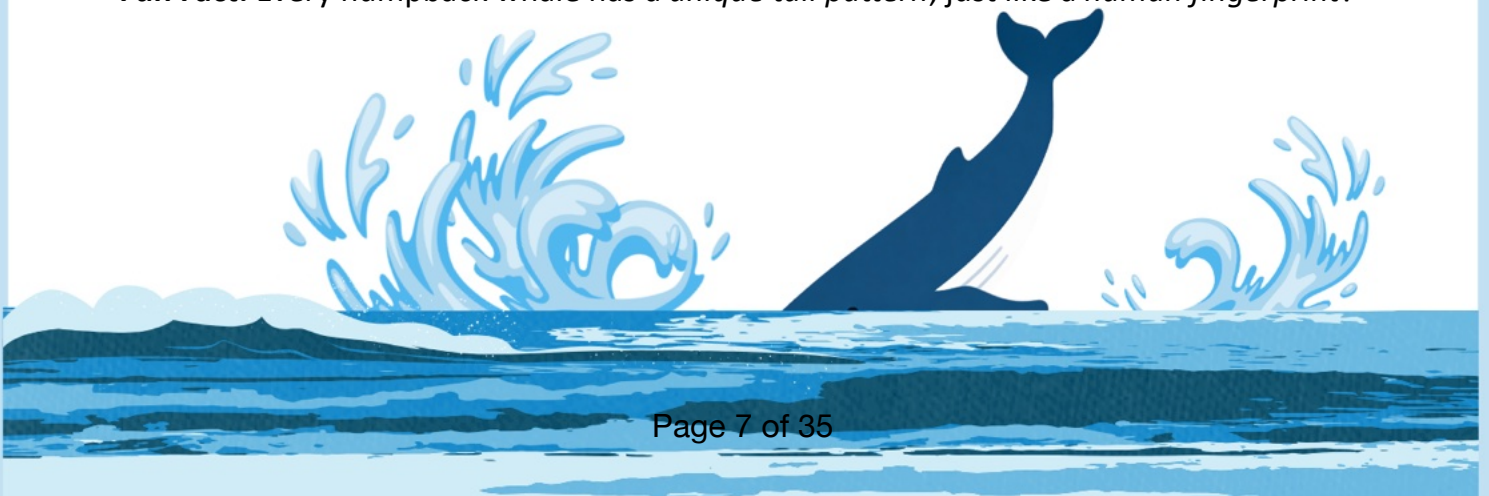
Humpback whales can grow as long as a school bus! Even though they are so big, they mostly eat tiny krill and small fish. They open their huge mouths like a giant net, scoop up lots of water, and then push the water back out while keeping the food inside.

Whales are mammals, so they breathe air through a blowhole on top of their heads.

I also learned that humpback whales are not kept in aquariums because they need the open ocean and swim very long distances.

Seeing whales in the wild made me want to help protect the ocean.

Fun Fact: Every humpback whale has a *unique tail pattern*, just like a *human fingerprint*!



 Cosmic Wonders

Every planet in our Solar System has its own story to tell. From blazing heat to icy cold, giant storms to hidden rings, each world is unique—and this time, we're exploring the unusual planet Uranus.

🪐 Uranus: Unusual, Unexplored, Unique, Unforgettable

By Debashis Chakraborty

On the night of March 13, 1781, English astronomer William Herschel spotted a tiny object moving through the sky with his homemade telescope. At first, he thought it was a comet. After more observations, astronomers realized it was actually a new planet—the first ever discovered with a telescope. It was named Uranus.

Uranus is one of the strangest planets in our Solar System. It spins almost completely on its side, tilted by about 98°. Scientists think a giant collision long ago may have knocked the young planet over. Because of this unusual tilt, each pole spends about 42 years in sunlight followed by 42 years in darkness.

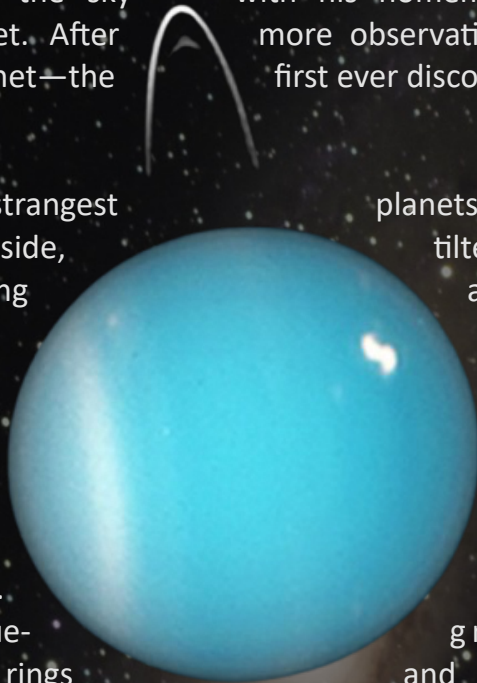
Uranus is also the coldest planet in our Solar System. Its atmosphere is made mostly of hydrogen, helium, and methane. The methane gives the planet its beautiful blue-green color. Uranus is surrounded by 13 faint rings, including the five largest - Titania, Oberon, Umbriel, Ariel, and Miranda.

More than 200 years after Herschel's discovery, Voyager 2 became the only spacecraft to visit Uranus. During its flyby in 1986, it revealed new rings, new moons, and the first close-up views of this icy world. Scientists hope that one day another mission will continue exploring this cold, distant planet and uncover even more of its mysteries.

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Titania



Oberon



Umbriel



Ariel



Miranda



A Recent Discovery

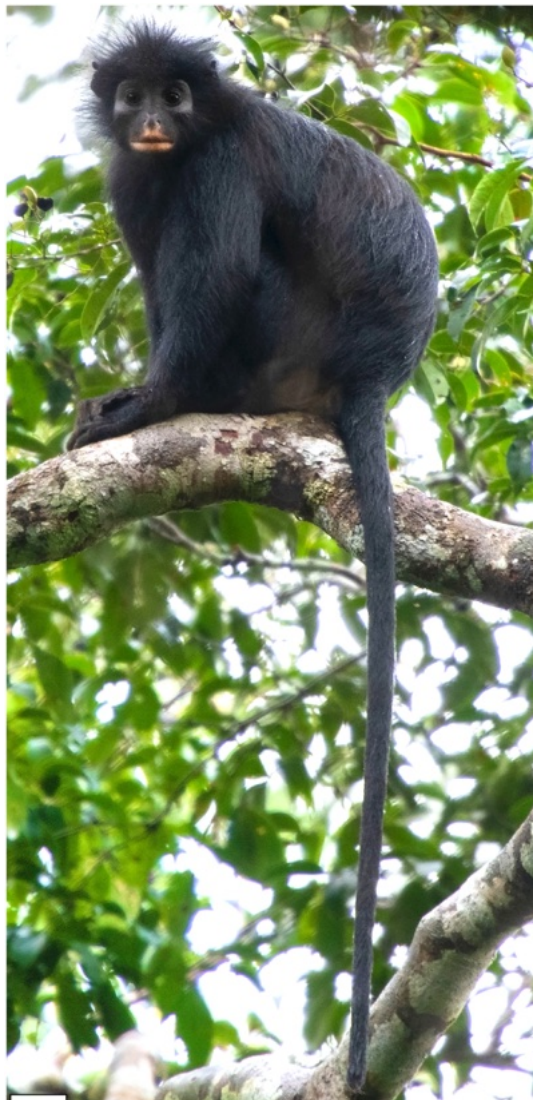
Even today, scientists continue to discover new species living in some of Earth's most remote places. Meet one of our planet's newest primates, found in the lush rainforests of the Congo.



Mystery Monkey of the Mighty Forest

By Debashis Chakraborty and Manavdip Saha

In the dense rainforests of the Democratic Republic of Congo, a new species of monkey has been discovered.



The story began in 2008, when conservationists captured a blurry photograph of an unusual black monkey in Lomami National Park. The natives already knew this animal and called it “Likweli”. Soon this photograph reached the scientific community who needed more evidence to understand exactly what it was.

Over the next several years, scientists studied the monkey by observing it in the forest, recording its calls, comparing its body features, and analyzing its DNA. After more than a decade of investigation, they confirmed that Likweli was a new species of colobus monkey, named *Colobus Congoensis*.

Likweli monkeys have orange patches around the mouth, gray cheekbones, black fur, a long tail, a strong body and a distinctive roaring call.

A new monkey species is rarely discovered—especially a primate. Likweli’s discovery is a reminder that there are several things in the world that people don’t know yet. It is the natural instinct of mankind to know the unknown. Human beings should always give their best to know about the world.



The background is a dynamic composition of paint splatters and brushstrokes in warm tones. Large, textured areas of orange and red dominate the center, with smaller, more delicate splatters of yellow, pink, and blue scattered around the edges. A horizontal white banner with a slightly distressed, hand-painted appearance cuts across the middle of the image.

CREATIVITY CORNER



Above the Clouds: A Conversation with a Pilot

Marie and Aadrita Interview Flight Instructor Dmitriy

Marie: Today my friend Aadrita and I are talking with my dad, Dmitriy. He is a commercial pilot and a flight instructor. Welcome!

Dmitriy: Thanks! I'm happy to be here.

Aadrita: Why did you decide to become a pilot?

Dmitriy: I always dreamed about flying. When I lived in Russia, it seemed almost impossible. But after moving to the United States, I discovered how many small airports and airplanes there are. Flying is much more common here. When my son Alex became interested in airplanes, I thought it would be wonderful to learn to fly together and show him that dreams really can come true.



Aadrita: What is your favorite part about flying?

Dmitriy: I love the feeling of freedom. An airplane can take you from one place to another much faster than driving. I also love seeing the world from above. Rivers, mountains, cities, forests, lakes, and the ocean all look amazing from the sky. Flying through clouds and then seeing bright sunshine above them feels like magic.

Aadrita: What is the most beautiful place you have ever flown over?

Dmitriy: The Grand Canyon is my favorite. Mount Shasta is incredible too, and I also love flying along the ocean coastline. Every flight shows you something beautiful.

Aadrita: What do clouds look like from above?

Dmitriy: They look like giant bowls of whipped cream stretching across the sky!



Aadrita: Have you ever seen lightning above the clouds?

Dmitriy: No. Small airplanes usually stay far away from thunderstorms because they can be dangerous.

Marie: How do pilots know when the weather is safe for flying?

Dmitriy: Before every flight, pilots carefully check the weather. We look at the weather where we are taking off, along the whole route, and where we are landing. We use special weather forecasts made just for pilots.

If thunderstorms are expected, we simply choose a different route and fly around them.

Marie: What would happen if an airplane flew into

a thunderstorm?

Dmitriy: Thunderstorms can have very strong winds that push airplanes up and down very quickly. That creates dangerous turbulence, especially for small airplanes. That's why pilots always avoid flying through thunderstorms whenever possible.

Aadrita: Have you ever had to change your route because of bad weather?

Dmitriy: Oh, yes! Many times. That's completely normal. Pilots change their plans all the time to stay safe.

Marie: Is it safe to fly at night?

Dmitriy: Yes, if the pilot has the right training. Flying at night is actually one of my favorite things to do. The air is usually smoother, there are fewer airplanes, and the stars and moon look beautiful from the cockpit.

Marie: How do so many airplanes fly without crashing into each other?



Dmitriy: Pilots follow special "rules of the sky," just like drivers follow traffic rules on roads. Air traffic controllers also watch airplanes on radar and help pilots stay safely separated. Everyone works together to keep flying safe.

Marie: Why do pilots use funny words like "Alpha" and "Bravo"?

Dmitriy: That's called the Aviation Alphabet. Some letters sound alike over the radio, especially if the signal isn't perfect. So pilots say Alpha instead of A, Bravo instead of B, and Charlie instead of C. It helps everyone understand each other clearly.



Pilots also use special words like Affirmative for "yes," Negative for "no," and Roger to mean, "I understand."

Marie: Can kids really fly an airplane?

Dmitriy: With a flight instructor sitting next to them, yes! I've even let my son Alex carefully hold the controls when he was about ten years old.

At age 16, someone can earn a Student Pilot Certificate and, after lots of training and their instructor's approval, fly an airplane alone for the first time.

At 17, they can earn a Private Pilot Certificate.

Aadrita: Were you ever scared when you were learning to fly?

Dmitriy: I was a little nervous before my very first solo flight. That's the first time a student flies without the instructor in the airplane.

But as soon as I took off, I stopped feeling nervous because I was focused on flying safely. I'll never forget that flight. Most pilots remember their first solo forever.

Aadrita: How fast and how high does your airplane fly?

Dmitriy: The airplanes I usually fly travel around 140 miles per hour. Most small airplanes fly below 12,500 feet, where there's still enough oxygen to breathe comfortably.

Aadrita: What happens if a pilot loses radio contact with air traffic control?

Dmitriy: Pilots train for that. First, we check that everything is working correctly. If the radio really isn't working, we follow special emergency procedures that every pilot learns during training. Air traffic controllers also know exactly what to do to help keep everyone safe.

I've never had that happen to me, but it's something every pilot practices.

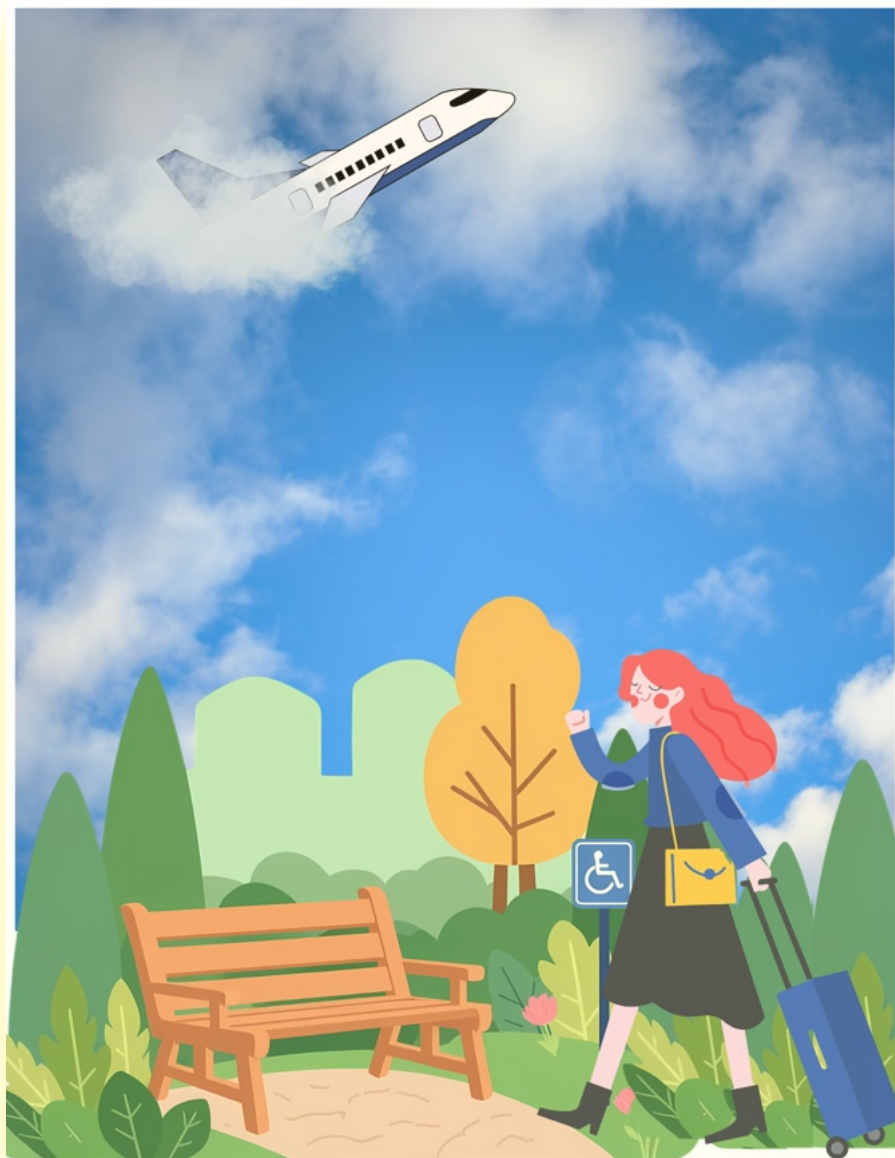
Aadrita: Have you ever seen the Northern Lights or a shooting star while flying?

Dmitriy: I haven't seen the Northern Lights yet, but I've seen incredible stars, a huge full moon, and beautiful moonrises from the cockpit. The night sky looks amazing from an airplane.

Aadrita: What advice would you give kids who dream about becoming pilots?

Dmitriy: Stay curious! Read books about airplanes and weather. Make paper airplanes. Fly kites. Build model airplanes. Try a flight simulator or fly a drone with an adult. Most importantly, keep asking questions and never stop learning.

You never know - one day you might be the pilot flying the airplane!





Amazing Airplane Facts! - from Pilot Dmitriy

1. You can become a pilot before you can drive a car!

In the United States, you can earn your Private Pilot Certificate at age 17, but in many states you can't get a full driver's license until you're 18. That means some teenagers can legally fly an airplane before they can drive a car by themselves!

2. Some kids in Alaska ride an airplane to school!

In the village of South Naknek, Alaska, there are no roads to the school. Instead of riding a school bus, students climb into a small airplane every morning! For them, the airplane is their school bus.

3. In some parts of Alaska, families use airplanes for grocery trips!

Some villages are so far away that there are no roads. People often travel by small airplane to buy groceries, or their food is flown in by airplane.

4. Airplanes can fly over giant traffic jams.

While cars may sit in traffic for hours, a small airplane can fly right over the roads and reach another town much faster!

5. Pilots don't steer with just a steering wheel.

Pilots use both their hands and their feet! Their hands control the yoke or stick, and their feet press special pedals called rudder pedals to help the airplane turn smoothly.

6. Every airplane has its own name tag.

Just like every person has a name, every airplane has a special registration number painted on its tail. In the United States, airplane numbers begin with the letter "N." No two U.S. airplanes have the same one!

7. Birds sometimes fly higher than airplanes!

Some birds, like bar-headed geese, can fly higher than 20,000 feet when crossing the Himalayas. That's even higher than where many small airplanes fly! They have special lungs that help them breathe in the thin mountain air.

Katherine's Reading Corner

This month's special:
Tumble and Blue by Cassie Beasley



A Book Review By Katherine Statz

Tumble and Blue is a great story, and it's one of my favorite books that I read this summer.



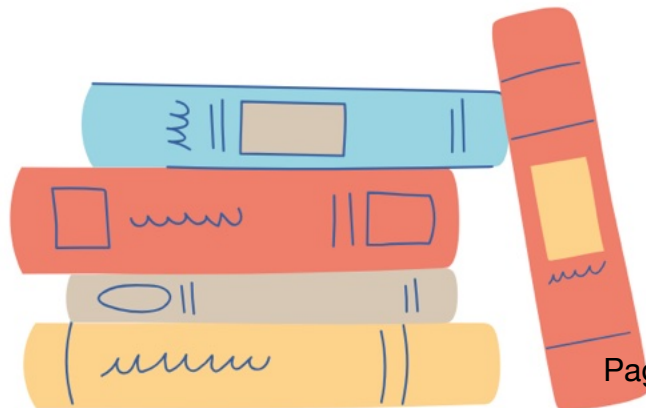
This middle grades fantasy adventure novel is about a child named Blue Montgomery who is cursed to lose at everything! Sadly, when his dad abandons him at his grandma's house, Blue finds out that all his relatives are cursed too.

Tumble Wilson is a hero in training, who is struggling to discover how she can help people, but whenever she tries to help someone, things go wrong.

When Blue and Tumble meet one summer, they try to find a mysterious creature who might solve all their problems. To find the golden crocodile, Munch, they must leave their homes in the middle of the night and travel through the swamplands of Georgia. Blue and Tumble learn to keep trying and never give up even when things seem hopeless.

My favorite parts were when Blue would almost win a game or contest, but the curse would stop him from winning and he would get hurt. The best part is that Blue kept trying and getting closer and closer to winning each time he tried.

Read this book to experience more amazing adventures to break the curse!



A friendship through Stories

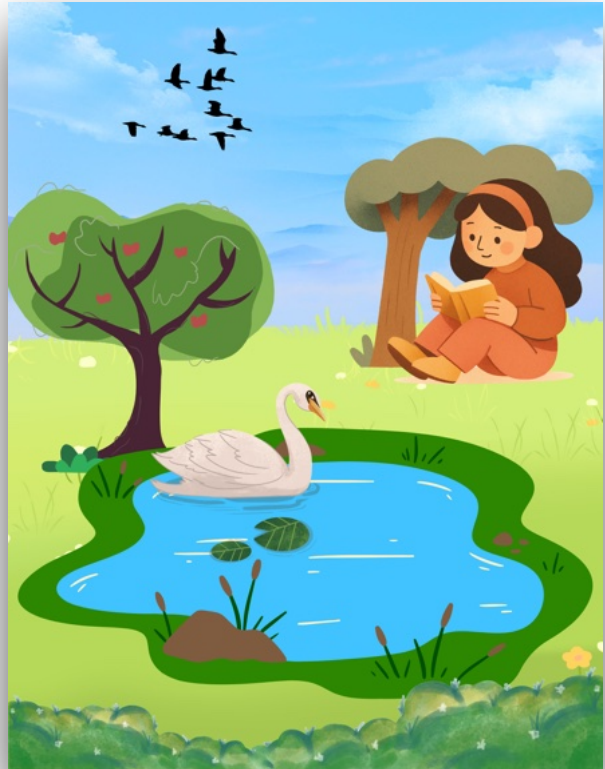
By Aadrita Chattopadhyay

A long time ago, there was a graceful swan living in a beautiful lake filled with lily pads. She used to swim across the lake and watch other animals play with each other. She wished to have a special friend of her own who will always be by her side.

One day, the swan noticed a little girl sitting by herself, holding a book. The girl looked sad. The swan slowly glided across the lake towards the girl. She heard the girl whisper: "I used to read my stories to my grandma. But she passed away, and I have no one to read them to."

The girl then noticed the swan didn't swim away. She stayed close to the shore, as if waiting to listen to her story.

The girl slowly opened her book and started reading. It seemed like the swan liked her story. The swan waited patiently until the very end of the story. As the sun began to set beyond the horizon, the girl closed her book and walked home. The golden light from the sky reflected off the lake like a mirror, and the swan again felt very lonely.

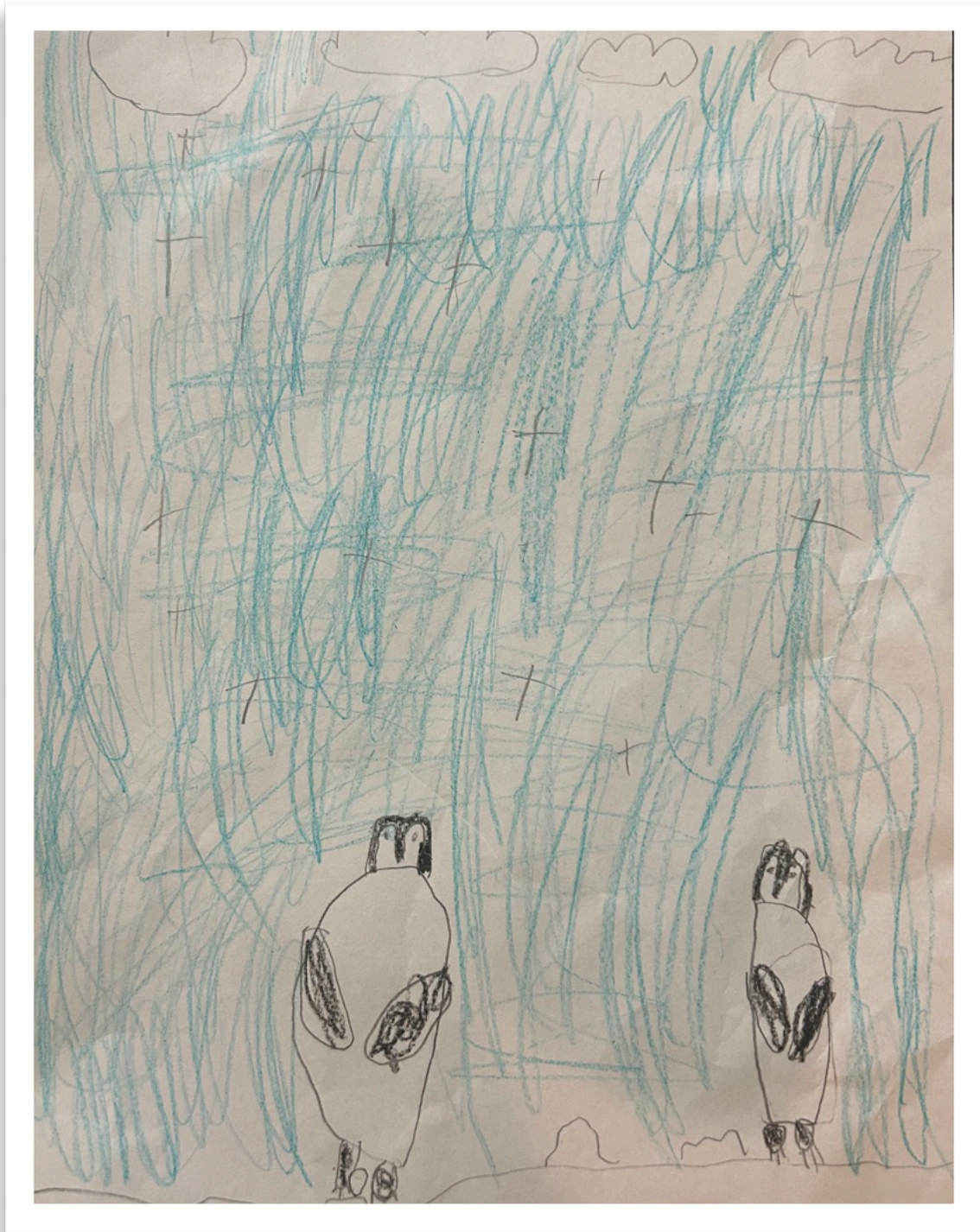


But the girl came back the next day with a new book. And the day after. Soon it became their new routine. Every adventure they shared together through the stories was filled with laughter, joy, hope, and sometimes tears. Over time, their friendship grew stronger and stronger.

Years passed. The little girl is now all grown up. She left town to go to college. Back in the lake, the swan still remembers the girl. And every evening, as the sun painted the lake golden, the swan waited by the shore, hoping another child with a story might come along.

Colors of Canvas

From the snowy landscapes of Antarctica comes this delightful painting by Charlotte Statz, celebrating one of the world's most fascinating birds - "The Emperor Penguins".



Fluttering through a world of flowers and sunshine, "Lily the Butterfly" is a delightful creation by Elenor Spaeth, celebrating the beauty and wonder of nature.



Pavel Steshenko unleashes his imagination with this magnificent dragon. Full of strength and mystery, it reminds us that art can bring every legendary creatures to life.



Through the Lens



A splash of pink brightens the day! This lovely flower was photographed by **Aadrita Chattopadhyay**, who captured one of nature's simple yet breathtaking creations.



The Champions' Challenge

Kick Off Your
Adventure!



Puzzle

Aviation Alphabet Mystery By Pilot Dmitriy

Every letter has a special code word to help pilots communicate safely around the world. Help Pilot Dmitriy solve the mystery! Read each clue, circle the correct aviation word, collect the secret letters, and discover the mystery word.



Aviation Alphabet Helper

A: Alpha	B: Bravo	C: Charlie	D: Delta	E: Echo	F: Foxtrot	G: Golf
H: Hotel	I: India	J: Juliett	K: Kilo	L: Lima	M: Mike	N: November
O: Oscar	P: Papa	Q: Quebec	R: Romeo	S: Sierra	T: Tango	U: Uniform
	V: Victor	W: Whiskey	X: X-ray	Y: Yankee	Z: Zulu	

Solve the Seven Clues

1. I am thinking of an animal with a fluffy orange tail. It is clever and likes to sneak around. What

letter does its name start with?

- I. Foxtrot II. Falcon III. Friend IV. Fox

Secret letter: ____

2. This word means someone you like to play with at school. The secret letter is R. Which aviation word stands for R?

- I. Rocket II. Robin III. Romeo IV. Rainbow

Secret letter: ____

3. This country is home to the Taj Mahal. The secret letter is I. Which aviation word stands for I?

- I. Ice Cream II. Island III. India IV. Igloo

Secret letter: ____

4. When you shout into the mountains, your voice comes back to you. That is called an...

- I. Eagle II. Engine III. Echo IV. East

Secret letter: ____

5. This is the month after October. Which aviation word stands for the first letter?

- I. North II. Noodle III. November IV. Night

Secret letter: ____

6. A river sometimes splits into many smaller rivers before reaching the sea. That place is called a...

- I. Dragon II. Door III. Delta IV. Dog

Secret letter: ____

7. A long yellow snake begins with the letter S. Which aviation word stands for S?

- I. Charlie II. Tango III. Sierra IV. Zulu

Secret letter: ____

MYSTERY WORD

____-____-____-____-____-____-____

Riddles

Half-time Brain Boost

It's halftime! While the players catch their breath, challenge your mind with these clever riddles. Can you answer them all before the second half begins?

1. I'm black and white and roll on the ground,
but only when kicked and passed around.
—— What am I?
2. I wear gloves and stop shots.
I dive and jump a lot.
—— Who am I?
3. I go on the field, but I don't play.
Players listen to what I say.
—— Who am I?



Answers:

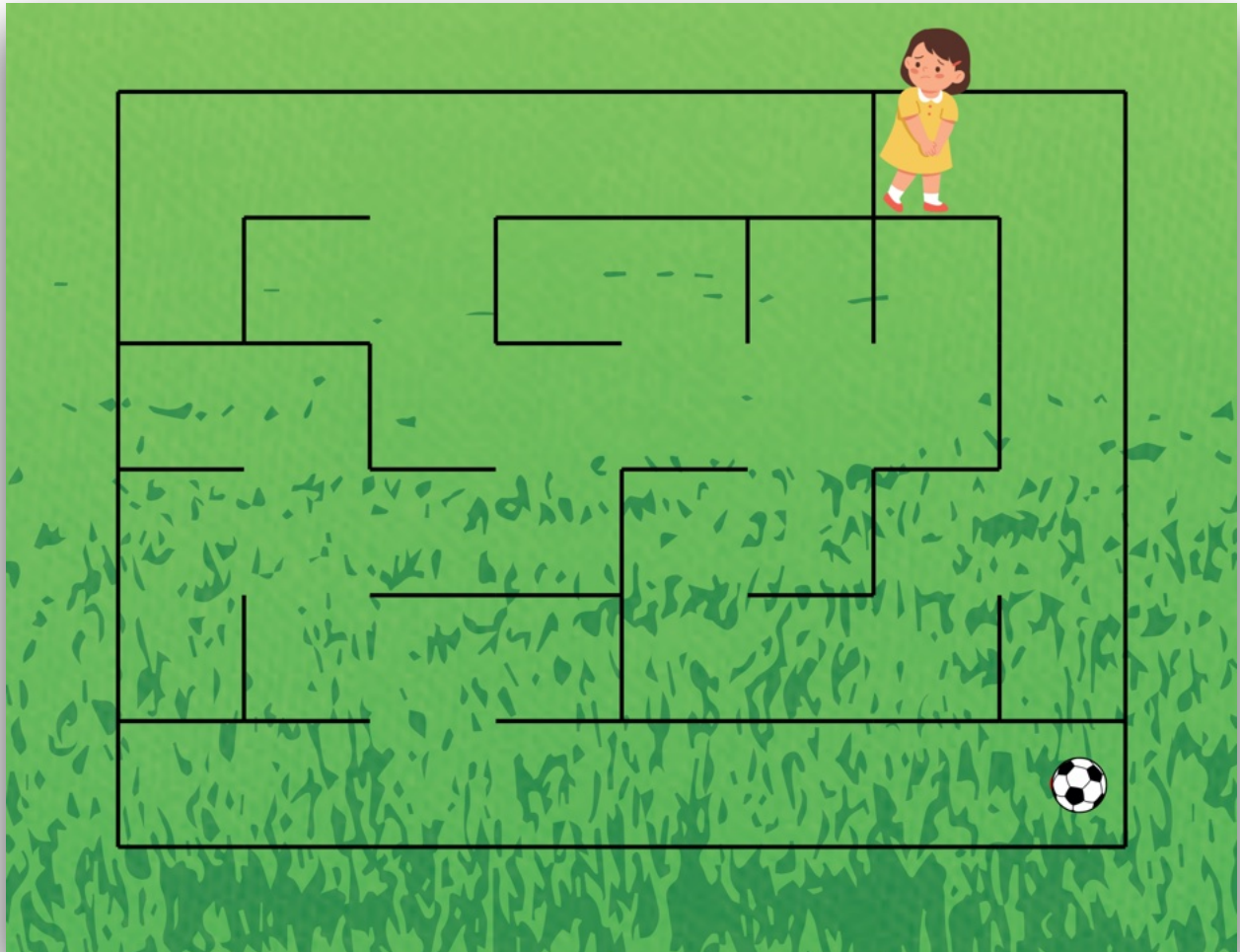
1. A Soccer Ball
2. A Goalkeeper
3. A Referee



Maze

Dribble Through the Defense

The goal is in sight, but a wall of defenders stands in your way! Find the best path through the maze and score the winning goal!



Spot the difference



VAR Review Challenge

VAR needs your help! A few things have changed on the pitch! Can your sharp eyes find all 6 differences before the final whistle.



Word Scramble

Locker Room Mix By Pavel Steshenko

Oh no ! Coach's game plan has been shuffled.
Unscramble the words to get the team ready for kick-off.

L-A-I-T

P-S-I-H

C-A-N-O-E

R-I-T-A-P-E

B-E-B-U-L-S-B

If you solve them all, please send your answers to us:
kabitri@gmail.com. We will feature the names of all our readers
who get the answers right in our next issue!

 Last issue's winner is  **Debashis Chakraborty.** 
Congratulations Debashis! Great job solving all the puzzles.

Answers to Last Issue's Word Scrambles:
FRIEND, PENCIL, SCHOOL, TEACHER, LIBRARY



Find the Words

Scout's Word Search By Aadrita Chattopadhyay

A soccer scout is searching for tomorrow's stars—and hidden words! Can you find them all before the other teams do?

W	T	R	O	P	H	Y	T	E	X	Z	F	L	A	G
U	F	R	Y	V	O	A	G	H	O	G	B	H	R	O
G	R	E	A	X	Z	E	O	F	R	Z	D	S	V	A
Y	V	F	W	H	I	S	T	L	E	E	S	D	X	L
D	H	B	R	K	F	B	U	W	F	S	C	V	U	L
O	F	F	S	I	D	E	M	T	E	V	S	R	E	D
U	T	Y	D	C	O	R	N	E	R	V	O	W	M	T
Y	P	W	E	K	R	T	G	A	E	A	C	Q	A	H
F	L	F	Q	B	I	D	K	M	E	C	C	H	T	Y
B	A	X	Q	V	U	Q	A	D	V	X	E	Y	C	G
C	Y	X	S	D	H	J	C	R	T	I	R	D	H	K
P	E	N	A	L	T	Y	Y	N	E	T	R	B	U	B
U	R	A	Z	Y	X	D	G	P	T	F	Y	U	T	O
W	S	U	K	J	B	G	H	V	Y	B	A	L	L	N
G	A	M	E	E	A	T	W	E	N	J	K	O	U	H

TROPHY

FLAG

CORNER

SOCCER

GOAL

OFFSIDE

WHISTLE

PENALTY

GAME

KICK

TEAM

MATCH

REFEREE

BALL

PLAYERS

NET

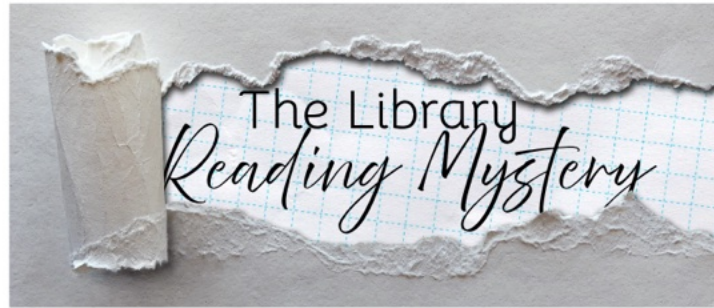
Mystery at the Library

Champion's Thinking Challenge

Reading, observing, and reasoning are just as important as running and scoring. Soccer stars make smart decisions every second on the field. Now it's your turn! Read the clues carefully and use logic to solve the library puzzle.

This mystery puzzle is created by Natalya Vinogradova.





Aadrita, Marie, and Pavel went to Gaithersburg library on Sunday.

Each child chose a different book:

- a book about mummies
- a book about weather
- a book about secret codes and encryption

Each child also read in a different place:

- by the window
- on the blue rug
- at the round table

The librarian forgot who chose each book and where each child sat.
Can you use the clues to solve the mystery?

How to Use the Evidence Tables

Write:

- ✓ when something is true.
- ✗ when something cannot be true.

Remember: Each child has only one book and one reading place.



Here are the Clues

- Marie read her book on the blue rug.
- The child with the book about mummies sat at the round table.
- Aadrita did not sit at the round table.
- Pavel did not choose the book about weather.
- The child who sat by the window chose the book about secret codes and encryption



Solve the Mystery

1. Which book did Aadrita choose?
2. Where did Aadrita read?
3. Which book did Marie choose?
4. Where did Marie read?
5. Which book did Pavel choose?
6. Where did Pavel read?

Bonus Questions

1. Who sat by the window?
2. Who read the book about mummies?
3. Which book was read on the blue rug?
4. Where was the book about secret codes read?



Use the Clues above and the Evidence Table below to answer the questions!



	The Books			Reading Places		
	Mummies	Weather	Secret Codes	Window	Blue Rug	Round Table
Aadrita						
Marie						
Pasha						



**Thank you for
reading our
Magazine**